

ity will make Indian farmers happy; nothing else can.

K.V. RAGHURAM, *Wayanad*

Bad Tidings

The spat between Samajwadi Party leaders Amar Singh and Mulayam Singh Yadav should not be surprising ("Costly Divorce", February 15). Indian politics has changed for worse. Earlier politics was driven by ideology and the aim was to serve society. Now everything revolves around individuals. As a result, some regional politicians are grossly misusing politics for personal benefit.

MADHU AGRAWAL,
Delhi

Classic Appeal

Your feature on actress Vidya Balan made for nostalgic reading ("Return of the Native", February 15). She was and has been the quintessential young Indian woman in Bollywood. She has conducted herself with dignity, having taken criticism related to her films and figure in her stride. And finally the actress has managed to retain her popularity at the box-office.

D. VINOD, *Ahmedabad*

Vote for a Cause

It was shocking to know that only 10 per cent of eligible youth voted in the last general elections ("Dreams for a New

Decade", February 15). What happened to the Jaago Re ads, and, more importantly, where were the rest of the 90 per cent youth? Such a laid-back attitude towards voting poses a serious threat to the future of our country's democracy.

JAYENDRA SONI, *Chennai*

Wake Up Call

It is a shame for democracy that people's repre-

Voting should be made compulsory for every eligible voter. Otherwise some incentive should be given to persons exercising their right to vote. Alternatives such as online voting on polling days should also be offered so that more people can vote for their preferred candidates from the confines of their homes or offices.

BHUSHAN JINDAL, *Jalandhar*



PHOTO DIVISION

“Infrastructure development needs to be given top priority. High interest subsidies should be provided for exports and corporate tax rates must be reduced to provide leverage for higher growth.”

V.K. TANGRI, *via www.indiatoday.in*

Corrigendum

The picture of Rajni B. Arora in our cover story ("New Hope for Cancer Patients", February 22) was incorrectly captioned as being taken at a walk organised by the Indian Cancer Society. The event was organised on February 7 by CanSupport and called Walk for Life: Stride Against Cancer. The error is regretted.

EDITOR

sentatives have to be shown a stick by the court to do what they ought to do ("A Bitter PIL", February 8). If people have to slog for years, visiting courts to make the government act, then what is the use of such a government? Activist Gerson da Cunha rightly observes that when 50 per cent of the electorate does not vote, how can we expect good governance?

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

APRIL 16-30, 1980

The Winds of Change

Gone are the days when the Congress was an umbrella party where people with all hues of political opinion could have free play. Those who have led the party back to power seem set on making it a pragmatic, result-oriented organisation—a party which can provide the dynamic force to a government that works. In the process, inevitably, much of the past would have to be shed. There would be no place for woolly ideologues or grumbling old men. Nor can such a party afford the luxury of scheming dissenters. Spearheading the new thrust in the party are Sanjay Gandhi and a whole new group of young men who have come to the fore with him. They claim it is they who saved the Congress from complete destruction, that it was they who fought the struggle for survival. Even though they are careful about articulating it yet, the new men are only contemptuous about partymen who are either dead-wood or those who were sucked in by the bandwagon effect of the party's victory.



SANJAY
WITH
INDIRA
GANDHI

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